from other countries can be gained from playing with and against them in the IPL.

Making the national team

The IPL has enabled many an Indian player to get noticed and subsequently make it to the national team and many others to come back into the reckoning. It was by virtue of their standout performances in the first season of the IPL that Yusuf Pathan and Ravindra Jadeja caught the attention of the Indian selectors. Similarly, Irfan Pathan made a comeback to the national side by doing well in the fourth IPL season and there are countless other examples.

While I agree that IPL performances are important enough to open doors to the national team, I am sure that IPL performances should only be used as a reason to pick a player for the Twenty20 format or, in exceptional cases, for ODI cricket. Playing well in the IPL does not make a player good enough for Test cricket, and arguably not fifty-over one-day cricket, for they require completely different skill sets. For those formats, selectors should continue to look at performances in the Ranji and Duleep trophies, the Irani Trophy and other domestic competitions.

Rewarding our past stars

One of the best legacies of the IPL is that it has allowed the BCCI to reward former cricketers who played for India at a time when there wasn’t much money on offer. While every player in the IPL is assured of a decent standard of living, many former Indian greats had to suffer hardship in old age. In a fantastic gesture during the fifth season of the IPL in May 2012, the BCCI decided to use the revenues generated by the competition to reward every player who had ever played for India. Even domestic players who had played a certain number of first-class games were brought within the ambit of this scheme. Such a gesture serves as huge encouragement for aspiring cricketers, who know that if they make the national team they will never have to worry about the basic necessities of life.

It was a nice touch that these special payments were presented during the play-off stages of the tournament in front of full stadiums, highlighting the achievements of these former servants of Indian cricket. This certainly wouldn’t have been possible without the IPL.